

third to paying off their mortgage. Controversial as it may be, I don't agree with Chilton. Interest rates are only going to go up. As rates continue to increase, the argument for putting every penny toward your mortgage gets stronger. If a fixed mortgage goes up to 7 or 8 percent, your rate of return is 7 or 8 percent. Good luck getting those kinds of returns with no risk and no volatility in the stock market!

When you get a mortgage, you want to design it so that you can pay it off as soon as possible. Don't invest in anything until you've paid it off. Think of every mortgage payment as an investment in your debt-free future.

The remaining 10 cents should go toward your Secret 10. It's a tax like any other, but it's the only tax in your life that you benefit from personally. The Secret 10 is a tax just for you. It's also your Catastrophe Cash Fund. If disaster strikes and you need cash, you'll have it. That's what it's there for.

How long will it take you to pay off your mortgage? Good question. Take a look at the following chart. Let's assume you owe \$200,000 and you've got a fixed-rate mortgage at 5.34 percent. You took my advice from my second book and are making biweekly payments. Here's what you'll be paying over four different amortization periods—including the total interest you'll accrue.

PAYING OFF YOUR MORTGAGE

LENGTH OF MORTGAGES	BIWEEKLY PAYMENT	TOTAL INTEREST PAID
20 years	\$621.48	\$48,560.24
15 years	\$740.75	\$46,835.54
10 years	\$987.11	\$41,789.11
5 years	\$1,751.21	\$27,635.14

Source: Table designed using data from Mortgage Payment Calculator, TD Canada Trust, 2013.